Riklr

AI FDE Intern *Case Study*

This case study is built on three problems from our past client work. Pick the one that interests you most and show us how you would fix it.

A Forward Deployed Engineer sits with the people who do the work every day. They go deep into each step to understand the real problem and then build a solution that fixes it. Each case puts you in that role with interviews, documents and data from a fictional client.

Deadline: Monday, 19 October 2026, 1 pm IST

THE CASES

Pick *one*

- **Vendor payments:** a North Indian real estate developer pays 900 vendors against printed bills that are checked by hand at each property and again at head office. Vendors end up waiting weeks for their money. Find out where the time goes and build a solution to fix it.
- **Sales analyst:** a global agri-inputs company plans its sales across 4 regions in spreadsheets and dashboards. Sales teams wait days for the data team to pull any number the dashboards do not show. Leadership wants an AI analyst they can ask instead. Decide the best way forward for the company and build that solution.
- **Talent sourcing:** a Middle East talent consultancy promises clients a shortlist within 10 working days. Its recruiters read every CV by hand in both English and Arabic and most roles take three weeks to reach a shortlist. Work out why shortlists arrive late and build a solution that gets them to clients on time.

Page 2 has more detail on each case and what its pack contains.

THE APPROACH

How to *approach it*

1. Read the context and go deep into the problem
2. Do secondary research to understand the problem better
3. Map the workflows that exist and find what is missing or causing problems
4. Weigh different solutions and pick the one with the most impact
5. Build a working prototype of it with a coding harness such as Claude Code

DELIVERABLES

A private *GitHub repo*

- **Code:** the working prototype with run steps in the README
- **Chat history:** full export of your coding harness including all the original prompts
- **Notes:** research and assumptions
- **Deck:** 10 slides or fewer that move from the problem and its context through the workflows to the solution and its impact
- **Video:** a narrated demo of 4 minutes or less on the problem and its context, the workflows isolated and how the working prototype solves it

WHAT WE LOOK FOR

How we *assess*

- **Problem:** how deeply the problem is understood and how clearly the biggest issue is isolated
- **Solution:** how well the options are compared and how clearly the chosen one shows its impact in numbers
- **Taste:** deep product thinking and a high-impact UI with no clutter

INTEGRITY

Original *work*

- Each candidate gets a unique version of the case, with markers that trace any copy to its source
- Copied work ends the application

The *cases*

PICK ONE

Company details are fictional. The problems come from our client work.

REAL ESTATE

Vendor *payments*

A North Indian real estate developer manages 38 residential societies, office towers and malls through its property management arm. About 900 vendors supply these properties with security guards, housekeeping staff, maintenance services and diesel. Together they raise 11,000 bills a year which are printed by vendors and handed over at the property desk. The property team checks each bill against the work order and the property head signs it off. Every week a courier carries the signed bills to head office where a central team of 5 checks each bill again before posting it in SAP. A problem found in either check sends the bill back to the property or the vendor by email. Each round trip adds to the weeks that vendors wait for their money. The CFO wants payments to move faster and believes AI that reads bills at head office could help.

IN THE PACK — The pack contains 7 stakeholder interviews and 40 bills in the form vendors send them, from clean PDFs to scans and phone photos. It also holds a year of bill records, attendance records and a stand-in for SAP.

MAIN SKILLS — The case tests document reading, rule checks and process mapping.

AGRICULTURE

Sales *analyst*

A global agri-inputs company sells seeds and crop protection products through distributors in 4 regions. Each region has its own sales team of regional managers and territory managers. Every quarter territory managers build their sales plans in spreadsheets and regional managers review them in monthly calls. To build these plans they need current numbers on orders, returns and payments for each distributor. Anything beyond the standard dashboards has to be requested from the data team and takes days to arrive. The company tried to close this gap last year with a chatbot for sales data. Leadership now wants an AI analyst that anyone in sales can ask, whether in team chat, in review meetings or by voice from the field app.

IN THE PACK — The pack contains 7 stakeholder interviews along with internal notes and metric definitions. It also holds 2 seasons of sales, returns and weather data in a warehouse that is ready to query.

MAIN SKILLS — The case tests data modelling, metric definitions and AI answers with guardrails.

TALENT

Talent *sourcing*

A Dubai-based talent consultancy recruits for companies across the Gulf. Its 35 recruiters work from offices in Dubai, Riyadh and Doha and fill roles for logistics, hospitality, banking and construction groups. Each new role starts with an intake call where the client's hiring manager describes the person they need. Recruiters then post the role, source candidates and screen the incoming CVs in both English and Arabic. The strongest candidates go to the client as a shortlist. The firm promises this shortlist within 10 working days but most roles take much longer. Recruiters say they spend most of their time reading CVs. The managing partner wants AI to help them screen CVs faster.

IN THE PACK — The pack contains 7 stakeholder interviews and about 50 CVs in English and Arabic. It also holds job descriptions, screening call notes and a year of hiring records. A stand-in for the firm's applicant tracking system completes the set.

MAIN SKILLS — The case tests document parsing in two languages, candidate matching and compliance.

SUBMISSION

How to *submit*

Submit by **Monday, 19 October 2026, 1 pm IST**. Late submissions are not reviewed.

1. Put the work in a private GitHub repo with run steps for the prototype
2. Add the video to the repo or share it as a Google Drive link
3. Invite the GitHub account named in the invitation email
4. Fill in the submission form linked in the invitation email with the repo link and video link